

Instructor Grooming Standards Manual

Men's & Women's Formal Wear Guidelines

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1. Purpose & Scope

This manual defines the measurable grooming and dress code standards applicable to all instructors at NxtWave. It applies uniformly across campuses and covers hair, eyewear, facial grooming, attire, accessories, footwear, and hygiene for both men and women.

Standards are written to be objectively checkable — each checkpoint below can be verified from a distance of 3 feet or on close inspection, removing ambiguity from grooming audits.

Approved attire options:

- Men: Formal shirt and trousers
- Women: Saree (3 days/week) or Kurti with dupatta (3 days/week), as per the notified weekly schedule

2. General Standards — Applicable to All Instructors

2.1 Hair

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Hair	Hair Combed	No loose/stray strands visible from 3 feet away
Hair	Hair Colour	No unnatural colours (blue, red, green highlights etc.)
Hair	Hairstyle — Men	Does not extend beyond collar
Hair	Hairstyle — Women	Tied, braided, or pinned neatly; loose hair acceptable only if it does not fall over the face while writing or facing the board
Hair	Hair Accessories — Women	Plain pins/clutcher only; no oversized clips, flowers, or decorative pieces during sessions
Hair	No Excess Products	No visible product buildup, wet or greasy appearance

2.2 Eyewear (Specs, where applicable)

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Specs	Lenses Clean	No smudges or dust visible under standard lighting
Specs	Frame Professional	Neutral tones only: black, brown, grey, navy, silver or gold
Specs	Proper Fit	Frames sit evenly; do not slide or tilt
Specs	No Damage	No cracks, broken hinges or missing nose pads

2.3 Hygiene

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Hygiene	Body Odour	No detectable odour within 1 arm's length
Hygiene	Breath	No detectable odour during normal conversation distance
Hygiene	Nails	Clean, trimmed; length does not extend beyond fingertip; no chipped polish

3. Men's Grooming & Attire Standards

3.1 Facial Hair

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Beard	Beard Trimmed	Edges defined; no stray hairs beyond 2 cm of face outline
Beard	Uniform Length	Beard length consistent across jawline and cheeks
Beard	Clean Shave	No stubble visible (if clean-shaved standard chosen)
Beard	Skin Condition	No visible cuts, razor bumps or ingrown hair
Beard	Moustache OK	Moustache does not extend beyond lip line

3.2 Shirt & Pants

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Shirt	Formal Attire	Collared formal shirt only
Shirt	Proper Fit	No pulling at buttons; no excess fabric bunching
Shirt	Ironed	No visible creases or wrinkles from 3 feet away
Shirt	Colour/Pattern	Solid colours or subtle patterns; no prints larger than 1 cm repeat
Shirt	Condition	No fading, pilling, stains or tears visible
Shirt	Neckline	Collar buttoned; not open more than one button
Pants	Formal Only	No denim, joggers, leggings or casual fabric
Pants	Proper Fit	Waistband at natural waist; no visible overhang or excess looseness
Pants	Ironed	No visible creases from 3 feet away
Pants	Condition	No fading, fraying or tears
Pants	Length OK	Hem touches top of shoe without bunching

3.3 Accessories

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Accessories	Jewellery	Max 1 ring per hand; stud/small earrings only (max 1 cm diameter)
Accessories	Watch	Single watch with plain dial; no oversized/sports/smart band
Accessories	Chain/Necklace	Single thin chain only; not visible above collar
Accessories	No Distracting Items	No bracelets or statement pieces during session

3.4 Footwear

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Footwear	Formal Shoes — Men	Leather or formal synthetic shoes only
Footwear	Clean & Polished	No visible dirt, scuff marks or dull finish
Footwear	Condition	No torn soles, broken straps or faded uppers
Footwear	No Casual	No sneakers, sandals, chappals or sports shoes

4. Women's Grooming & Attire Standards

4.1 Saree

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Saree	Drape	Pallu pinned neatly at shoulder; no sagging or trailing loosely below hip
Saree	Pleats	Front pleats even in width, tucked flat with no bunching at waist
Saree	Pallu Length	Falls between hip and knee level; not dragging on the floor
Saree	Blouse Fit	Fits without gaping at back/sides; no visible safety pins or straps
Saree	Blouse Neckline	Not more than 4 inches below collarbone, front or back
Saree	Blouse Sleeve	Half-sleeve or full - sleeve only; no sleeveless during sessions
Saree	Petticoat Length	Not visible below saree hem when standing or walking
Saree	Fabric / Color	Solid colors or subtle prints only; no sheer/see-through fabric without proper lining
Saree	Condition	No fading, fraying, snags, or visible stitching repairs
Saree	Ironing	No visible creases from 3 feet away, especially on pallu and pleats
Saree	Waist Fit	Sits at natural waist; no visible midriff when arms are raised normally

4.2 Kurti with Dupatta

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Kurti	Length	Falls at or below mid-thigh; no slits above knee
Kurti	Fit	Not tight-fitting at bust/hip; no visible outline of undergarments
Kurti	Neckline	Not more than 4 inches below collarbone; no plunging necklines
Kurti	Sleeve	Elbow-length or full-sleeve only; no sleeveless during sessions
Kurti	Side Slit	No higher than knee-level, if present
Dupatta	Presence	Worn at all times during sessions; not carried over arm or bag
Dupatta	Draping Style	Draping style is at the instructor's discretion, provided it looks formal and neat
Kurti	Fabric/Pattern	Solid colours or subtle prints; no prints larger than 1 cm repeat
Kurti	Condition	No fading, pilling, stains, or tears visible
Kurti	Ironing	No visible creases from 3 feet away
Kurti	Bottom Wear	Palazzos or churidar in matching or neutral tone; ankle-length, no cropped or casual fabric

4.3 Makeup

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Makeup	Foundation	Even, skin-toned; no visible lines or patches
Makeup	Lip Colour	Nudes, pinks, mauves only; no red, burgundy or dark shades
Makeup	Eye Makeup	Neutral liner/mascara only; no coloured eyeshadow or glitter
Makeup	Overall Look	Natural appearance; no heavy contouring visible from 3 feet

4.4 Accessories

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Accessories	Watch	Single watch with plain dial; no oversized/sports/smart band
Accessories	Bangles/Chudi	Max 4–6 thin bangles per wrist; no more than 1 loud/statement bangle
Accessories	Bindi	Small, plain, matching or neutral tone only; no oversized or glitter bindis
Accessories	Earrings	Studs or small earrings only (max 1 cm diameter); no jhumkas or hanging/dangling earrings
Accessories	Mangalsutra/Chain	Single chain visible is acceptable — culturally standard, not a violation
Accessories	Nose Pin	Small stud only; no oversized nose rings during sessions
Accessories	No Distracting Items	No anklets or statement pieces during session

4.5 Footwear

Area	Checkpoint	Measurable Standard
Footwear	Formal Footwear — Women	Closed or open-toe formal heels/flats/juttis in neutral or matching tone; no flip-flops or sports sandals
Footwear	Heel Height — Women	Max 3 inches, for safety and mobility while walking between classrooms
Footwear	Clean & Polished	No visible dirt, scuff marks or dull finish
Footwear	Condition	No torn soles, broken straps or faded uppers
Footwear	No Casual	No sneakers, sandals, chappals or sports shoes

5. Notes for Auditors

- All checks should be conducted from a standing distance of approximately 3 feet unless the criterion specifies close inspection (e.g., nails, footwear polish).
- Cultural attire elements (mangalsutra, bindi, bangles) are standard and not treated as violations unless they exceed the stated limits.
- Where a criterion allows a range (e.g., bangle count, heel height), auditors should apply judgment consistently across all instructors.
- Any deviation should be discussed privately with the instructor before being logged, in line with NxtWave's grooming feedback protocol.